SAEED MD ABDULLAH

PhD · Sustainability Reporting · Accounting & Finance · Financial Auditing

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PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth: 27 June 1988 | **Nationality:** Bangladeshi | **Permanent Address:** 133/3 (2nd Floor), Shahid Faruque Road, West Jatrabari, Dhaka – 1204, Bangladesh

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

PhD-qualified researcher and financial auditor with expertise in sustainability reporting, climate change disclosure, and accounting. Three years of professional audit and tax compliance experience across different corporate sectors. PhD research on environmental reporting and climate change disclosure from institutional, financial, and political perspectives. Methods include meta-regression in R, Python-based textual analysis, and qualitative content analysis of comment letters, applied across international and European contexts. International academic background across five countries. Specialist in non-financial reporting with research-informed expertise in IFRS S2, ESRS E1, ESRS, CSRD, and working knowledge of double materiality principles.

CORE COMPETENCIES

• Sustainability Reporting	• ESG Disclosure Analysis	• Climate Change Disclosure
• IFRS S2 / ESRS / CSRD	• ESRS E1 / EFRAG	• Non-Financial Reporting
• Financial Auditing & Compliance	• Financial Accounting	• Tax Compliance
• Textual Analysis (Python)	• Meta-Regression & Econometrics	• Content Analysis

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Financial Auditor / CA Articleship (3-year programme completed) Nov 2012 – Nov 2015
Howladar Yunus & Co. and Ashraf Uddin & Co., Chartered Accountants | Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Audited financial statements and tax accounts for corporate and individual clients in compliance with Bangladesh Accounting Standards (BAS/IAS), Income Tax Ordinance 1984, and VAT Act 1991; prepared and submitted income tax returns and assessments for companies and individuals.
- Audited cash incentive files under Foreign Exchange Circular 9 (Bangladesh Bank); developed expertise in export documentation and back-to-back LC processes.
- Conducted factory inspections, corporate consultancy, and government incentive calculations as financial auditor throughout the three-year CA Articleship period.

2016–2018: Following completion of CA articleship, continued working at audit firms for a short period and subsequently worked as an Accountant at US-Bangla Airlines for a short period (both without work experience certificates), then pursuing IELTS preparation and international university applications, leading to a full scholarship offer at Mahidol University, Thailand (commenced April 2018).

ACADEMIC & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

PhD Researcher Nov 2021 – Mar 2025
IUSS Pavia & University of Trieste | Italy

- Doctoral research (3 papers): moderating effect of institutional characteristics on environmental performance and environmental disclosure using meta-regression in R; value relevance of quality and quantity of climate change disclosure of EuroStoxx 600 companies using Python-based textual analysis including parts of ESRS E1; and analysis of comment letters in IFRS S2 standard-setting (Visiting Scholar, Glasgow).
- Produced three working papers on environmental reporting; presented at international conferences like EAA Annual Congress 2025, EUFIN workshops, SIDREA and others.
- Ad hoc reviewer for EAA Annual Congress 2026 and Journal of Environmental Management; session chair at EAA Annual Congress 2025.
- The PhD research was supervised under Professor Paola Rossi from University of Trieste

Visiting PhD Scholar Mar 2024 – Aug 2024
Adam Smith Business School, University of Glasgow | Scotland, UK

- Collaborated with Prof. Alvise Favotto on deductive content analysis of IFRS S2 comment letters; applied Bitonti's (2020) public interest framework to analyse lobbying behaviour across stakeholder groups.

Teaching Assistant Oct 2023 – Oct 2024 (2 semesters)
DEAMS, University of Trieste | Italy

- Delivered exercise-solving classes in Financial and Managerial Accounting for first-year Bachelor students under Prof. Michele Bertoni; 20 contact hours per semester (2 semesters).

Educational Tutor Oct 2023 – Oct 2024 (2 semesters)
DEAMS, University of Trieste | Italy

- Provided academic tutoring in Accounting for first-year Bachelor students under Prof. Michele Bertoni; 50 tutoring hours per semester (2 semesters).

EDUCATION

PhD in Sustainable Development and Climate Change Nov 2021 – Mar 2025 (Defended 26 March 2025)
IUSS Pavia & University of Trieste | Italy

MSc Accounting | Grade: 14.335/20 Sep 2020 – Jul 2021
Toulouse School of Management, Toulouse 1 Capitole University | France

MSc International Financial Management | Grade: 3.80/4.00 | Full Scholarship Apr 2018 – Feb 2020
College of Management, Mahidol University (CMMU) | Bangkok, Thailand

MBA, Major Finance | Grade: 3.23/4.00 May 2011 – Apr 2012
East West University | Dhaka, Bangladesh

PUBLICATIONS & WORKING PAPERS

Publication: Abdullah, S. M., & Zaby, S. (2021). Seasoned equity offerings and differences in share-price impact by firm categories. *International Journal of Financial Studies*, 9(3), 36.

- Abdullah, S. M., Peressin, G., & Rossi, P. "Moderating effects of institutional characteristics on environmental disclosure and performance: A meta-regression." Working paper.
- Abdullah, S. M., & Rossi, P. "Value relevance of climate change disclosure: Evidence from EuroStoxx 600 companies." Working paper.
- Abdullah, S. M., & Favotto, A. "Lobbying on climate change disclosure: Evidence from IFRS S2." Working paper.

SKILLS

Technical: Python (textual analysis of climate change disclosures: readability, sentiment analysis, cosine similarity, keyword frequency, relevant sentences) · R (meta-regression analysis) · MS Excel

Standards: IFRS / IAS · IFRS S2 · ESRS E1 · ESRS / CSRD · EFRAG · BAS (Bangladesh Accounting Standards) · Income Tax Ordinance 1984 (Bangladesh) · VAT Act 1991 (Bangladesh)

Languages: English — Professional proficiency · Italian — Elementary (A2, developing toward B1) · Bengali — Native

AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Fully funded PhD fellowship, IUSS Pavia & University of Trieste, including €6,000 for research activities (2021–2025).
- Full academic scholarship, International Master Program in Finance, Mahidol University, Thailand (2018–2020).
- European Accounting Association (EAA) — Member ID: 207351 | Centre for Social and Environmental Accounting Research (CSEAR) — Member ID: IND-25-013

REFERENCES

References available upon request.

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